

holding off until the last minute uses the power of “negotiation” to your advantage, but we don’t agree. Put yourself in the shoes of the other party and treat them with respect. This also goes for any other stage of the home-buying process—though the seller is opposite you in this transaction, they’re still a human who wants to sell their house as quickly and smoothly as possible.

WRAPPING IT ALL UP

The last step in the home inspection process is to submit the inspection objection notice to the seller before the deadline. As we’ve said many times before, you are making a *request*, not a demand—and the seller is under no obligation to comply with any or all of it. They can come back and say yes to some portions of your request and no to others, and you’ll probably go back and forth with negotiations on certain requests that neither party wants to budge on.

At this point, you’re incredibly attached to this house—you can try to stay aloof, but trust us, it’s going to happen. You’ve jumped through hoops and spent time and money preparing to purchase this specific property. You’re getting (or at least should be) a great price on a suitable home.

Determine what’s important to you and what would make you walk away. While it may be tempting to throw in the towel with a few of your requests rather than give up on this house, you don’t want to be stuck with a basement full of sewage unless you’re fully prepared to wade through it (both metaphorically and literally).

If you are asking for no repairs or credits, you’ll need to release the inspection contingency so you can move forward with the transaction. If the report has come back with deal breakers or the seller won’t comprise, submit your Notice of Termination along with the Earnest Money Release form so you can receive your earnest money back and start your search again.

Sometimes, that’s just the way the cookie crumbles. It’s better to let the cookie crumble rather than the questionable foundation of your new home.